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Take the First Step

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Free media and discipleship resources for pastors, leaders, and growing disciples.

Take the First Step

Today's Reading: John 10:31-39

Hearing God's Voice for Today:

"If I am not doing the works of my Father, then do not believe me; but I do them, even though you do not believe me, believe the works, that you may know and understand that the Father is in me and I am in the Father."

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Some of the people who saw Jesus doubted him. In a sense, they put him on trial. But when this happened, it wasn't him who was on trial. It was those who examined his life who were on trial. And the same is true about people today—including you.

In what way are you on trial? By the way you examine Jesus' works. By how you look at his miracles. One after another, they are paraded before you in Scripture. They all beg for an answer to this question: Who alone but God could perform such mighty works?

Examine them all. Look at the water being changed into wine. Look at those freed from the tyranny of demonic oppression—proving Jesus' power is greater than the devil's. Look at the thousands who were fed by him with only a paucity of food. The blind saw. The lame walked. The sick were healed. And the dead were raised.

Jesus performed these miracles to help those in need. They were signs for spiritual skeptics to believe in him—both then and now.

These signs show, beyond doubt, that the Father and the Son are one.

Have you carefully examined his miracles as revealed in his Word? When done, you will find that they speak loudly and clearly to his identity.

What else does this mean for you today? If the Father and the Son are one and you're a believer, then both live in you now. This is a promise for all who believe in Jesus. Think about this truth: The power that created the universe now lives in you!

More specifically, the fact they live in you means that you can face anything that comes your way. Their strength in you is greater than any problem you will confront. The Jesus who lives in you is greater than he, the devil, who lives in this world.²

What giant are you facing today? God is greater than the problem. Don't look at the size of your giants. Look at the size of your God who lives in you. And remember: God's fruit is most delicious where the giants are the biggest.

Now take the first step toward your problem. You can't be victorious if you stay put. As you do, strength will arise. You will gather supernatural momentum. You will discover you can do all things through the Lord as he gives you strength.

Trust him. As you keep moving forward, remember his miracles. They prove his power. He did them then. He still does them now.

Remember, Jesus can't steer a parked car. That's why you need to take the first step. No matter what the situation, God is your refuge and strength. He is always ready to help you in times of trouble. You should never fear when earthquakes come and the mountains crumble into the heart of the sea. His power is greater than your problem.

Experience his power flowing through you. And then watch your giants be slain—all for his glory!

[from *"Hearing the Voice of God"* by Pastor David Chadwick, *Moments of Hope Church, Charlotte, NC*]